

Engineering Supplier Verification Checklist

For overseas buyers evaluating Chinese suppliers before deposit, production, or shipment.

Use this checklist to decide what evidence you need before trusting a supplier quotation. It is designed for engineering and construction material packages such as precast concrete, steel structures, MEP components, construction materials, and project equipment.

How to use: score each section from 0 to 3. 0 = unknown, 1 = weak evidence, 2 = acceptable with gaps, 3 = clear evidence. Any critical unknown before deposit should trigger a supplier question, document request, or verification visit.

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SOURCE RATING

1. Supplier Identity and Business Legitimacy

☐ Legal company name matches quotation, bank account, invoice, and export documents.

☐ Business license, registration status, address, and operating scope reviewed.

☐ Factory address is confirmed and not only a sales office or trading address.

☐ Export entity is identified: manufacturer, trading company, or related export company.

☐ Website, catalogs, certificates, and sales claims are consistent.

☐ Ownership, related companies, and obvious litigation or blacklist signals checked where available.

Buyer question: Who owns the production process and who will be contractually responsible for quality and delivery?

SOURCE RATING

2. Engineering Documents and Technical Fit

☐ Supplier has received and acknowledged drawings, specifications, standards, and tolerances.

☐ Key technical requirements are translated into an inspection checklist.

☐ Supplier can explain critical dimensions, materials, finishes, embedded parts, or welding/coating requirements.

☐ Drawing revision control is agreed before production starts.

☐ Samples, mockups, first-article inspection, or trial production are defined when needed.

☐ Open technical questions are listed with responsible person and due date.

Red flag: Supplier only discusses price and delivery, but cannot respond to drawing-specific questions.

SOURCE RATING

3. Factory Capability and Capacity

☐ Workshop, equipment, molds, lines, tooling, and workforce match the quoted product.

☐ Current workload and available capacity have been checked against promised delivery date.

☐ Subcontracted processes are identified: welding, galvanizing, coating, machining, testing, packing, or assembly.

☐ Production flow is clear from incoming material to final packing.

☐ Bottlenecks and capacity constraints are documented.

☐ Similar past projects or production examples are reviewed with evidence.

Buyer question: Which processes are done in-house, and which are outsourced?

SOURCE RATING

4. QA/QC, Certificates, and Traceability

☐ Incoming material inspection and traceability process reviewed.

☐ Material certificates, test reports, and compliance documents match the order requirements.

☐ In-process and final inspection records are available and credible.

☐ Nonconformity handling and corrective action process is visible.

☐ Inspection responsibility is clear: factory QC, third-party inspector, buyer engineer, or all three.

☐ Hold points are defined before irreversible steps such as casting, coating, packing, or shipment.

Red flag: Certificates are available but cannot be linked to batch, heat number, lot, or production record.

5. Production Monitoring and Schedule Risk

☐ Production schedule includes critical milestones, not only final shipment date.

☐ Supplier provides weekly progress evidence for long or high-risk orders.

☐ Delay risks are linked to materials, labor, subcontracting, tooling, approvals, or testing.

☐ Rework and quality drift are tracked before shipment.

☐ Change requests and drawing revisions are recorded.

☐ Escalation path is agreed if progress falls behind plan.

Buyer question: What evidence will we receive each week that production is on track?

6. Pre-Shipment Inspection and Release

☐ Quantity, model, markings, labels, packing list, and visible condition checked.

☐ Dimensions, finish, workmanship, coating, welding, assembly, or other key features spot-checked.

☐ Packaging method is suitable for export, handling, weather exposure, and project site storage.

☐ Photos are taken for goods, labels, packing, defects, corrections, and loading readiness.

☐ Final documents are consistent: invoice, packing list, certificates, test reports, and shipment marks.

☐ Shipment release recommendation is explicit: release, hold, correct, recheck, or request more evidence.

Red flag: Supplier pushes for shipment release before documents and packing are complete.

SOURCE RATING

7. Risk Scoring Matrix

Score each category from 0 to 3:

0 = unknown / not checked

1 = weak evidence / high uncertainty

2 = acceptable but with gaps

3 = clear evidence / low concern

[] Supplier identity: ____ / 3

[] Engineering document fit: ____ / 3

[] Factory capability: ____ / 3

[] QA/QC and traceability: ____ / 3

[] Production schedule: ____ / 3

[] Shipment readiness: ____ / 3

Decision guide: 15-18 = proceed with normal controls. 10-14 = proceed only with corrective actions. 6-9 = verify before deposit or shipment. 0-5 = high risk; pause and investigate.

8. Supplier Questions to Send Before a Visit

1. Please confirm the exact factory address where our order will be produced.
2. Which processes are performed in-house and which are subcontracted?
3. Please provide recent QA/QC records for a similar product.
4. Please provide material certificates and explain how they link to production batches.
5. What are the main production risks for our order and how will they be controlled?
6. What are the proposed inspection hold points before shipment?
7. Who is the technical contact responsible for drawings, revisions, and quality questions?
8. Can you share packing photos and loading readiness evidence before release?

9. When to Request Source Rating Support

Request a desk check when you have a supplier link but need a quick first-pass risk review.

Request a factory verification visit before deposit, supplier approval, contract signature, or high-value order confirmation.

Request production monitoring when delays, rework, or hidden quality drift could create project cost.

Request pre-shipment inspection before goods leave the factory.

Free early-stage offer: send one supplier link, product category, project country, and your main concern. Source Rating can provide a concise first-pass risk screen for suitable engineering material inquiries. On-site visits, lab testing, legal opinions, and multi-supplier sourcing are separate paid scopes.

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